

Who Will Govern The Net?

The blueprint for the world's first Internet Governance Forum (IGF), to be held at the end of October, has been laid out. This is a UN experiment devised when countries were unable to agree on who should run the Internet. Hopefully, we'll see something substantial emerging from the Forum.



Cell-Based Computers Shipping

IBM has finally started shipping computers based on the Cell architecture it co-developed with Sony and Toshiba. IBM claims that a number of high-profile clients such as the Fraunhofer Institute are already running the devices.



Enter

Tarun Tahiliani
Fashion Designer

Tahiliani is a leading fashion designer who held his first solo show at London in 1994, and has since been amongst the best in the Indian fashion industry. His collections merge Indian ethnic chic with contemporary international appeal.

Technology to you is...

...Mostly a nightmare—great for production in mass, often soulless, but it really makes life comfortable.

What gadgets do you use?

The gadgets I use extensively are PCs, iPods, great music systems, digital printers, and, actually, a host of other appliances. My mobiles are critical in my daily life.

What would be your dream gadget/technology?

My dream technology would have to be a time machine—using which I'd be able to go into any time of history, reverse aging, and condense travel time.

What do you mostly do online?

E-mailing... I still find it too slow and impersonal to surf the Net.

Any instance where technology has really helped you?

In my business, where printing technology on paper and fabric has enabled us to be much more efficient. Also, to stay cool, stay in touch, and enjoy mobility.

"The world is my oyster"!

PRETTY WITH A PUNCH

MS Unleashes Live Search

It's charming, pretty, XP-esque, and feature-packed—MSN's new Live search (accessible from live.com) launched September 12. The index is questionable, though—your mileage may vary, but a search for a random actress, both in Web pages as well as in images, brought up only a tenth of the number of results that Google did, and the ratio with a popular technology term was 50! One might ask why anyone would want to use Live search in such a situation, but when you realise that people hardly ever go beyond the third page of results, and want more relevance instead, the question becomes an idle one.

We can't do a review in this space, and neither is one warranted, but one look at the image search will reveal that Windows Live Search is all about functionality, looks, and user-friendliness. As just one example, when we did a search on the random actress, we got a list of "similar people." It's a refreshing break from the boring Google we've all gotten used to, although it's slower.

As part of Microsoft's plan to call everything

"Live", the old search.msn.com now redirects to live.com. It's only a matter of time before all user experience comes under the Live brand umbrella.

In addition, Microsoft has also unveiled the final versions of Live.com in general and Windows Live

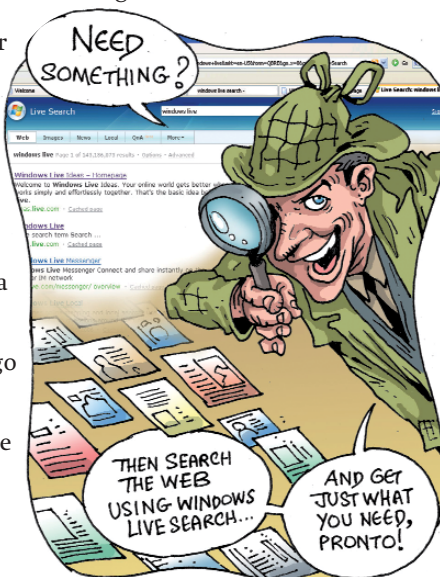
to your homepage by clicking on a link. There are also additional sites where information is filtered using specific search criteria. These include academic.live.com, which lets you search academic journals and content for article titles and abstracts, author names, and so on.

The Windows Live Toolbar has also been released, replete with a pop-up blocker and protection against phishing attempts. Windows Live Local is based on Microsoft's Virtual Earth platform.

Industry experts, as well as the rest of us, naturally see Windows Live Search as Microsoft's latest offensive against rivals Google, Yahoo!, and AOL.

Coming to the numbers, Microsoft's market share in Web search is going down. It currently ranks third, behind Google and Yahoo!. The company had 9.6 per cent of the market in July, down from 11 per cent in January, according to Nielsen/NetRatings. Google and Yahoo! had picked up in that period. However, Derrick Connell, general manager of Microsoft's search business unit has said, "I feel confident that we can gain share."

Gain share they will, if the user experience is anything to go by. Again, a comparative review of Google vs. Yahoo! vs. Live



Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

Local (for local search in some countries).

At Live.com, you can create tabs to pages featuring self-selected information. Links can be chosen from a menu of news sites and blogs compiled by Microsoft, or favourites compiled by other users while conducting searches. For example, if you stumble upon a supported blog or site you like, you can add it